E-Commerce Sales Analysis

Key Insights & Business Observations | Dataset period: 01 Jan 2011 – 31 Dec 2014

1. Project Snapshot

Measure	Value shown in dashboard
Total Sales	$12.65M
Total Profit	$1.47M
Total Orders	About 25K
Average Discount	14.29%
Rows with missing Profit	14

The dashboard shows total sales of $12.65M and total profit of $1.47M. The approximate overall profit-to-sales ratio is 11.6% (calculated from the displayed totals). Treat this as a high-level ratio, not a margin for every product or region.

2. Main Insights from the Analysis

- **Regional sales:** Central is the largest sales region at about $2.82M, followed by South at about $1.61M and North at about $1.25M. Canada is the smallest at about $0.07M. Sales are not evenly distributed across regions.
- **Product categories:** Technology has the highest category profit at about $0.66M, followed by Office Supplies at about $0.52M and Furniture at about $0.29M.
- **Customer segments:** The Excel segment chart shows Consumer contributes about 52% of sales, Corporate 30%, and Home Office 18%. Consumer is the largest segment in this view.
- **Top-selling products:** The leading products by sales include Apple Smart Phone, Full Size; Cisco Smart Phone, Full Size; Motorola Smart Phone, Full Size; Nokia Smart Phone, Full Size; and Canon image CLASS 2200 Advanced Copier.
- **Loss-making products:** The Excel summary identifies five products with negative profit, with combined losses of about $25.41K. High sales do not always mean high profit.
- **Sub-category profit:** The Power BI waterfall shows different profit contributions by sub-category, including at least one negative contribution. Check the underlying results before making product-level decisions.
- **Order and shipping patterns:** Medium is the most common order priority and Standard Class is the most common shipping mode in the dashboard. Counts alone do not show that one option causes better performance.

3. Recommended Business Actions

- Review the five loss-making products to understand their discount levels, costs, and sales patterns before changing prices or promotions.
- Study the Central region's sales pattern and compare it with lower-sales regions. Do not assume one strategy will work everywhere.
- Protect the strong Technology category while checking profit at sub-category and product level.
- Use Consumer as an important customer group, while exploring opportunities in Corporate and Home Office.
- Evaluate discounts using profit as well as sales.